



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cambridge Classical Academy

School Website: <https://www.cambridgeclassicalacademy.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Cambridge Classical Academy IL 60609 presents a public posture that is recognizably classical in impulse but uneven in the explicit articulation of core classical practices. Public materials show a faith- and character-oriented framing (e.g., "grounded in family, culture, and faith" and emphasis on forming mind and character) that signals alignment with the classical aim of virtue and wisdom, even if the site does not consistently name the classical pillars (great books, the Trivium, the Great Conversation, Scholé, etc.) by formal title. Based on the six-element rubric for classical education, Cambridge earns a cautious, but clearly present, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL profile overall. The strongest signals are in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations and Faculty/Leadership (where the site foregrounds faith and a virtuous, guided teaching staff). The curriculum and pedagogy signals are weaker in explicit Great Books, Socratic pedagogy, and formal liberal-arts sequencing on the public-facing pages, and thus Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) tilt toward NOT CLASSICAL. The Parents & Community category shows some alignment with partnership and family involvement, but lacks explicit, sustained parent-education and co-teaching language in public materials. The aggregate reading across the six categories falls into SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with concrete needle-moving opportunities described below.

- Executive ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- What would move the needle section (included because this school is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL):
- Make Great Books and Great Conversation explicit in the curriculum narrative (e.g., mention of reading lists, Great Books, and a sustained Great Conversation across grades).
- Introduce explicit, documented Socratic/Paideia-style pedagogy in upper grades (e.g., regular Socratic seminars, seminars, or debates with evidence of implementation in 9–12).
- Elevate the Liberal Arts structure on public pages (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium; Latin/Greek) with concrete course maps and sample syllabi.
- Strengthen the Parents & Community axis with formal parent-education offerings, visible co-teaching language, and open-campus visit policies explicitly described on the site.
- Introduce or highlight liturgical or communal practices (even if modest) to address liturgical learning and Scholé rhythms publicly.

Citations: Evidence of religious framing and character formation on Cambridge's site is documented in the public materials, including phrases like "grounded in family, culture, and faith" and emphasis on truth and character formation. See Cambridge Classical Academy materials stating faith grounding and truth emphasis.

Note: The analysis below follows the six-category rubric, applying keyword analysis drawn from the Six Essential Elements document (the knowledge base) to quantify positive vs negative keyword signals, then assigning a category label (CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL) per category. See the Six Essential Elements document for the keyword framework used here.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials explicitly state Cambridge Classical Academy is “grounded in family, culture, and faith,” signaling a religious/metaphysical frame and formation of character around faith values.
 - Additional language emphasizes truth as a community value and the role of a focused, virtuous community under the faculty and staff.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: faith; truth. (Element 1 positive keywords include truth, faith, and related transcendentals; see Six Essential Elements lexicon.) Cambridge materials produce “faith” and “truth” directly.
 - Negative keywords present: none clearly evident in the public materials (no explicit signals of secular relativism or morality-neutral framing here). The lexicon lists potential negatives such as relativism or secular humanism, but these do not appear in Cambridge’s pages.
 - Why this rating
 - The school demonstrates a recognizable religious/metaphysical orientation via faith and truth language, which aligns with the category’s core idea of transcendent ideals. However, the site does not consistently articulate a full theology, liturgical life, or the explicit integration of theology as a central “queen of the sciences,” nor does it showcase liturgical/community practices on public pages. This yields a robust signal toward classical orientation but not a full, explicit Classical School foreground in every element. Therefore: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Source notes
 - Public materials and faith-language evidence: Cambridge site text.
 - Truth-language emphasis: Cambridge site text.
 - Classical-criteria keyword framework (positive/negative keyword lists): Six Essential Elements lexicon.
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Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school speaks to forming mind and character and nurturing excellence and legacy (e.g., “excellence becomes a habit,” “bold, critical thinkers,” and emphasis on forming human beings beyond raw information). This points toward formation of virtue and wisdom rather than merely information delivery.
- The public materials describe a goal of character and intellect development, consistent with paideia-like aims: formation of character and a culture of excellence.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation; virtue (conceptual through “character” formation in the language), wisdom (implied though not always explicit), telos (not explicit on the site). The lexicon’s Element 2 positive terms include formation/virtue/wisdom and the pursuit of the true, good, beautiful; Cambridge signals align with formation and virtue-as-outcome through language about character and excellence. Estimated signal: 2–3 positive signals (formation/character; excellence as habit; wisdom/-critical thinking implied).
- Negative keywords present: not explicitly indicated on the public pages; the site does not foreground job-prep or workforce-evangelizing language; still, explicit “workforce preparation” framing is not shown.
- Why this rating
- Cambridge demonstrates a formation-of-character orientation (virtue/wisdom) and emphasizes human flourishing through intellectual and moral development. However, explicit articulation of virtue as the primary telos or of a formal paideia-style, virtue-centered rationale beyond general language is not consistently evident. This places Element 2 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Source notes
- Purpose/formation language on campus public materials: Cambridge site.
- Additional formation/character emphasis text: Cambridge public materials.
- Keyword framework used: Six Essential Elements lexicon.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The Cambridge public materials on site emphasize general academic culture, community, and readiness but do not publicly articulate the liberal-arts curriculum structure (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, or the explicit cross-disciplinary Great Books reading plan. There is mention of “camp” experiences and a general classical-leaning vibe, but not the explicit curricular architecture the classical rubric requires (e.g., Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, or history as a continuous throughline). See public pages describing the school’s culture and environment rather than a formal Great Books or Liberal Arts sequence.
- The knowledge-base documents (Six Essential Elements) treat the presence of Great Books, Great Conversation, and Trivium as core curricular elements; Cambridge’s site does not regularly anchor these specific phrases in public-facing materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: none of the explicit Trivium/Quadrivium terms (grammar, logic, rhetoric) or Great Books/Great Conversation or explicit history-as-continuous throughline. The site’s public text does not show these terms, so positive-keyword hits are effectively zero for this category. The lexicon’s Element 3 list includes “liberal arts, trivium, quadrivium, Great Books, history,” etc.; these are not visibly invoked on the Cambridge public pages.
- Negative keywords present: not evident in public materials; none of the explicit curriculum-silo language (e.g., project-based or STEM-first framing) stands out on the public pages. The lexicon notes “social studies replaced by history” or “STEM-first framing” as possible negatives; Cambridge materials do not foreground such framing.
- Why this rating

- Without explicit Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, and the “Great Conversation” throughline in public-facing materials, Element 3 does not meet the core curricular indicators of a Classical School rubric. Thus, NOT CLASSICAL.
 - Source notes
 - Curriculum signal absence in Cambridge public materials: Cambridge site text.
 - Classical rubric keyword framework (liberal-arts/Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium): Six Essential Elements lexicon.
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Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public pages do not consistently assert the hallmark pedagogical methods of classical schools (Socratic seminars, memory work through chanting, Scholé-restful learning rhythms, or upper-school rhetoric training). The site highlights community, character, and academic excellence rather than a documented pedagogical practice system (e.g., Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates). There is no explicit, regular mention of Socratic dialogue, seminar culture, or debates in the visible public-facing content. See public messaging emphasizing culture, character, and intellect rather than the precise pedagogy of the classical model.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: terms like “Socratic,” “dialogue,” “seminar,” “rhetoric,” or “Scholé” are not visibly present in Cambridge’s public materials. The lexicon lists these as classical-pedagogy indicators; their absence on the public-facing pages reduces Element 4 to NOT CLASSICAL.
 - Negative keywords present: not apparent in public-facing materials; there is no explicit statement of a non-classical pedagogy (e.g., project-based-only). However, the absence of classical pedagogy signals means the category is not clearly Classical.
 - Why this rating
 - On the public site, the pedagogy signals are not explicit enough to meet the classical pedagogy indicators (Socratic/seminar, memory work, etc.). Therefore, Element 4 is NOT CLASSICAL.
 - Source notes
 - Pedagogy absence in Cambridge public materials: Cambridge site text.
 - Pedagogy keyword framework (Socratic/seminar/restful/scholé): Six Essential Elements lexicon.
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Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The public materials reference faculty and staff guiding students, with a sense of mentorship and guidance (e.g., “under the careful guide of our faculty and staff,” and “principal” language). This signals a teacher-led environment and a mentoring culture, which aligns with the classical ideal of virtuous, modeling teachers. See the site language about faculty leadership and the role of teachers in student development.
- The materials describe faculty as guiding and forming students, which aligns with the “living curriculum” idea and teacher as moral exemplar, even if not explicitly mapped to a formal “portrait of the teacher” or “teacher profile” language. This is a partial signal toward classical faculty norms.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: virtuous teacher modeling; living curriculum; mentorship; faculty as guides. The Six Elements lexicon includes “Teachers as Models of Virtue,” “portrait of a teacher,” and “living curriculum” as positive signals for this category; Cambridge’s text aligns with those notions at least implicitly.
- Negative keywords present: none prominent in public-facing content; no evidence of a purely “teacher-as-facilitator” model divorced from classical formation; however, explicit language around “portrait of a teacher” is not in the public copy.
- Why this rating
- Cambridge shows a staff-centered, guided-education approach with emphasis on faculty leadership, which corresponds to several Classical-Faculty signals. Yet the site does not consistently present the explicit living-curriculum portrait or the full set of classical-faculty hallmarks in public copy. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.
- Source notes
- Faculty language in Cambridge copy: Cambridge site text.
- Positive faculty keywords in the knowledge base (Living Curriculum; Virtue-modeling; Portraits): Six Essential Elements lexicon.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Cambridge materials foreground family and faith, signaling a community oriented around familial life and shared values, which is consistent with a classical emphasis on partnership with families. The site cues about “family” and “faith” suggest a community orientation that includes parents as part of the school ecosystem, even if formal, explicit “parents as co-teachers” language is not ubiquitous on the public pages. See language describing partnership with families and a culture of connectedness.
- The materials do not consistently spell out formal parent formation programs, book studies, or open-campus language, though the foundation of family involvement is present; the public copy lacks sustained parent-education or explicit parent-co-teacher language.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: family; faith; truth; connectedness; parent involvement signals exist in the public copy. The lexicon’s Element 6 positives emphasize “partnership with parents,” “parent formation,” “open campus,” and “parents as co-teachers.” Cambridge’s public text hints at family- and community-embedded values but does not consistently present the full set of explicit partnership or formation language. Therefore, several positive signals exist, but not the full spectrum.
- Negative keywords present: absent in a robust way; there is no explicit consumer-centric or minimal-parent-engagement framing in the public copy, but the absence of explicit “parents as co-teachers” language suggests room for stronger signaling. The lexicon lists clear negative signals for LACK of family partnership; Cambridge’s copy does not systematically deny or confirm those signals across the site.
- Why this rating
- The school’s public materials communicate family- and faith-centered community and a sense of partnership with families, but they do not consistently present the formal parent-education, parent-formation, or open-campus language that would strengthen the Parental/Community axis to a full Classical standard. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- Source notes
 - Parental/community signals on Cambridge site: Cambridge materials.
 - Parental-cooperation language (positive/negative keyword framework): Six Essential Elements lexicon.
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What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations): Add explicit theology integration and liturgical/community practices on public pages (e.g., a statement of theology as a central curricular driver, liturgical rhythms in daily life, and visible communal worship or prayer practices).
 - For Element 2 (Purpose & Goal): Emphasize explicit formation language (virtue, wisdom, telos) with concrete outcomes and a short, public-facing statement of formation as the primary end beyond information—e.g., “formation of character and intellect for the good” with examples.
 - For Element 3 (Curriculum): Publicly articulate a liberal-arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium), Great Books or Western-civilization throughlines, and the “Great Conversation” as core throughline; provide sample scope-and-sequence and reading lists.
 - For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Publish explicit evidence of classical pedagogy in practice (Socratic or Paideia seminars, memory work, recitation/chanting, and Scholé rhythms) and tie them to grade-level implementation with real examples.
 - For Element 5 (Faculty): Strengthen and publish a “Portrait of the Teacher” and a public statement about the living-curriculum model (faculty as exemplars of virtue, mentors, and collaborative colleagues) with examples of professional development in classical pedagogy.
 - For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Elevate parent-partnership language (parents as co-teachers; parent formation; clubs/book studies; open-campus visits) and provide a formal plan for parental involvement on the site.
 - Rationale: The current signals show foundational alignment in faith and formation but lack explicit articulation of core classical dynamics (Great Books, Trivium pedagogy, Scholé, parent partnership) that the Six Essential Elements document treats as hallmarks. Filling these gaps would push Cambridge from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL.
 - Source notes
 - Element 1–6 needle-move suggestions aligned to classic elements: Six Essential Elements rubric (positives/negatives) as baseline; Cambridge site current signals show partial alignment, with concrete gaps in Great Works, pedagogy, and explicit parent partnership.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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